

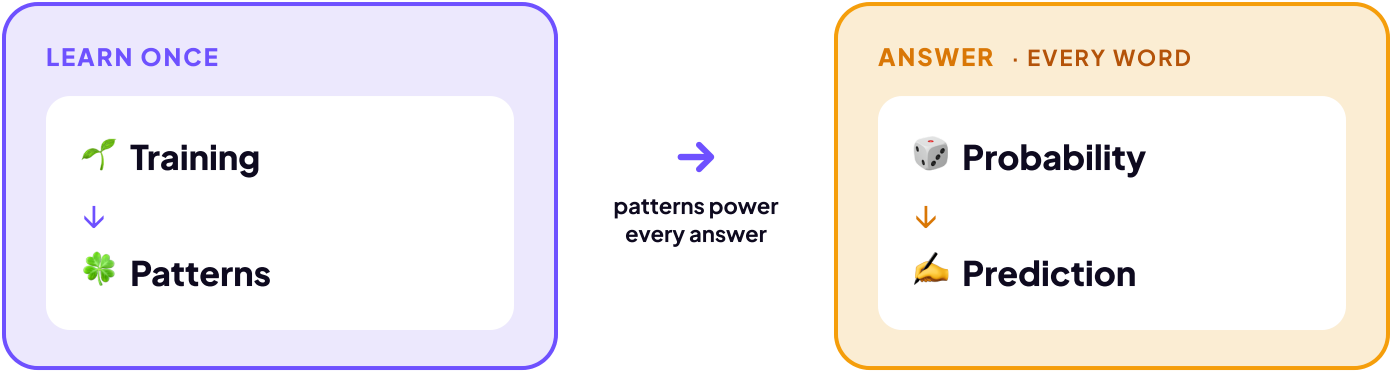
What AI Does Best

AI will take on almost anything you ask: writing, planning, summarizing, coding, drawing, whatever you throw at it. But trying and being good at it are two different things, and AI is far better at some kinds of work than others.

We saw this firsthand building this course. AI coded every page and every interaction you’ll see, and we give it a grade of **A+**. It also wrote the first drafts of all lessons, but only earned a **C-**. It made points in the wrong order, added explanations that missed what we meant, and had no real feel for how a lesson should flow.

This gets at the core idea of the lesson. Writing software code is all about patterns, and AI is a pattern-making machine, so it aces that job. But writing strong lessons doesn’t follow a set pattern, so AI can help, but it can’t do the whole thing.

What AI does best is based on the mechanisms you already learned: Training, Patterns, Probability, and Prediction.



Point those four mechanisms at real work, and they become the things AI does best.

AI is built to do four things really well.

Pattern matching

Patterns in, patterns out.

Code is patterns. So is reformatting data, or turning an outline into prose. AI trained on millions of examples and learned each pattern. Hand it any input and it predicts the pattern that fits.

GOOD FOR

- Coding
- Reformatting messy data
- Pulling fields out of documents
- Turning an outline into prose

Vast exposure

Seen a thousand of these before.

Training gave AI more material than any human will read in a lifetime. So for most everyday questions, it has seen many versions of yours, and many examples of how good answers get shaped.

GOOD FOR

- Brainstorming angles
- First drafts of common documents
- Explaining at any level
- “How do people usually handle...” questions

Compression of meaning

Finds the signal in long stuff.

It boils long text down to its core meaning, then pulls the relevant parts back out. Long documents get split into chunks, each one condensed into a summary it can search. Pull specific answers out of long material in seconds.

GOOD FOR

- Summarizing
- Extracting key points
- Finding the relevant section in a long document
- Translation

Probabilistic generation

Ten versions in ten seconds.

It builds each answer one small piece at a time, each piece a best guess chosen from many options. Same prompt, different output every time.

GOOD FOR

- “Give me 10 variations”
- Rewriting in a different tone
- Alternative phrasings
- Creative options

Four engines. A thousand uses. Almost everything AI is good at is one of those four strengths pointed at the right task. The skill isn’t memorizing a hundred clever prompts. It’s spotting which strength a job needs, noticing when none of them fit, and knowing when one fits but you still shouldn’t reach for it.

TRY IT

AI is strong at some kinds of work and weaker at others. Match each task to the strength it plays to.